



STATUS REPORT

Lesotho: status report

Edition of 2026-08-31 • 156 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-31 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/LS0/Ledger.csv](#) (156 systems and instruments, 4 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

[SUMMARY OF POSITION](#) • [GOVERNANCE](#) • [FINANCE](#) • [ICT INFRASTRUCTURE](#) • [DPI](#) • [DIGITALISATION](#) • [TECHNOLOGY](#) • [CAPACITY](#) • [INCLUSION](#) • [DATA](#) • [GEOPOLITICS](#) • [GAPS TO FILL](#)

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Lesotho's current position rests on a payments and social-protection layer that has been running for several years, and a policy layer signed in the middle of 2026 whose texts are not on file. The [LeSwitch](#) national switch clears instant payments, ATM withdrawals and card transactions at point of sale inside the country across four commercial banks, and the mobile wallets that sit on it now carry a [licensed retail investment product](#). The social registry holds data on [more than 90% of households](#). Against that, the framework governing personal data is a statute from 2011 whose supervisory commission [has never been appointed](#).

The three foundational policies — broadband infrastructure sharing, data management and artificial intelligence — were [signed on 12 June 2026](#), and the wiki holds the reported signings rather than the instruments, so what each requires, of whom and by when cannot be stated from the base.

The largest commitment on the record is Project Kobong, [approved on 31 July 2026](#): at least 1,200MW of pumped-storage hydropower paired with an AI data centre at Mokhotlong, on an agreement binding as to process but conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements, with construction targeted for 2029. The maloti figure is the government's throughout; [Convalt Energy's own release](#) of 8 June 2026 confirms the agreement and the capacities and states no value.

An interim national CSIRT [began operating on 29 July 2026](#) while the two bills that would give it a statutory footing await National Assembly approval, and the National Cybersecurity Strategy the launch was described as implementing is not held here.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12
Data Management Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12
National AI Policy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12
National AI Strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Drafting workshop opened in Maseru 2026-08-17
National Digital Policy 2024	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issued in 2024
National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in 2024

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bureau of Statistics Act 2001	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Act 8 of 2001, establishing the Bureau and the national statistical system
Cybercrime Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Awaiting National Assembly approval, 2026-07-29
Cybersecurity Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Awaiting National Assembly approval, 2026-07-29
Data Protection Act 2012	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Act 5 of 2012; section 52 governs cross-border transfer of personal information
Electronic Transactions and Electronic Communications Bill 2022	PLANNED ↗	Recorded as pending promulgation in the National Digital Policy
Fourth Statistics Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Officials expect enactment before the end of 2026
National Assembly Electoral (Amendment) Bill 2026	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Senate adopted the legislation committee's report, 4 June 2026
National Identity Cards Act 2011	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Act 9 of 2011, commenced 2013
Payment System Bill 2025	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Second reading moved by the finance minister, 5 May 2026
Payment Systems Act 2014	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Act 11 of 2014, governing payment systems and instruments
VAT (E-Invoicing) Regulations 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Legal Notice 25 of 2026
AI legislation or regulations	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31	No AI Act or regulation found; the 2025 policy is the stated foundation

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bilateral health agreement with the United States and its data-sharing instrument	IMPLEMENTED, TEXT WITHHELD ↗	Signed in December 2025, stated at US\$364m
Data Protection Act 2011	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force since 2011
Data Protection Commission	PLANNED ↗	Provided for by the 2011 Act; no commissioner appointed as at 2026-03-23

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
50-in-5 DPI campaign membership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joined as the fourteenth member, May 2024

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
African Union Data Policy Framework domestication	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Readiness workshop convened by AUDA-NEPAD, 28-31 July 2025
SADC cross-border digital identity framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Partnership announced to build a federated regional eKYC ecosystem
SADC Real Time Gross Settlement system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Lesotho one of four founding pilot countries
Smart Africa Alliance membership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Announced alongside the sixth SADC cyber drill, hosted in Lesotho

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
LCA Quality of Service Rules (Legal Notice 41 of 2023)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023 gazetted, in force 2023-04-21
Lesotho Standards Institution	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Declared operational by the trade minister, September 2020
MOSIP identity platform adoption	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Continued under the 2026 work plan with UNICEF

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Allegation of interference in regulator appointments	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Allegation made at a media briefing, August 2026
Communications consumer perception survey	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2026 survey published by the communications authority
Public digital services experience survey	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened 2026-08-09

Two instruments carry the framework: the National Digital Policy 2024 and the National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030. Three more — broadband infrastructure sharing, data management and artificial intelligence — were signed in June 2026 and none of the texts is held; all three were already reported under development in the [2025/26 budget speech of 19 February 2025](#), more than a year before signature.

The [LCA Quality of Service Rules](#), gazetted 21 April 2023, set the one published, binding standard in this area, with minimum thresholds for voice, data, postal and courier licensees. The LCA's [Annual Report 2024/25](#) recorded 75% overall compliance across twelve general parameters for the year to 31 March 2025, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time; its [Q3 2025/26 drive-testing](#) in Maseru, November 2025, measured mean LTE download speeds of 2.88-2.95 Mbps against the Rules' 25 Mb/s target.

Personal data is governed by an Act in force since 2011. The Data Protection Commission it provides for was still unappointed as at March 2026, which is stated by [Cenfri](#) rather than by the government. No regulator is therefore in place to approve, audit or refuse a data flow.

Regional alignment is convened rather than completed. A four-day AUDA-NEPAD workshop on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework [ran in July 2025](#), and no readiness assessment, legislative review or resulting instrument from it is held. Lesotho joined the [50-in-5 campaign](#) as its fourteenth member in May 2024.

No government open-data portal is held. An [SBC4D/IREX capacity assessment](#) prepared for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency, dated September 2021, found no active government open-data programme, a civil-society Lesotho Open Data Initiative launched in 2019, a ranking of 151st of 187 countries in Open Data Watch's 2020 Open Data Inventory, and no access-to-information legislation in force.

The one governance instrument that is known to exist and known to be withheld is the bilateral health agreement with the United States, [signed in December 2025 and stated at US\\$364m](#). A [FOIA complaint filed on 2 April 2026](#) records that the State Department briefly published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and that the related data-sharing agreements have not been published; Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	M381.1 million allocated to the ICT sector, delivered in the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Development-partner support for the data blueprint	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy named as supporters of the first workshop

A domestic budget line for digital transformation is on record for the first time. The [2025/26 budget speech](#), delivered 19 February 2025, allocated M381.1 million to the ICT sector and named a Government Security Operations Centre, a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network, 17 already-operational base tower stations and a 96km Roma-Thaba-Tseka fibre stretch under way.

Development-partner support for the National Data Value Creation Blueprint — Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy — was named as supporting its [first workshop](#), with no programme document, terms of reference or amount published.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Econet Khonahala bundle tariffs	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Promotional bundle terms published, October 2025
Econet Telecom Lesotho 5G network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	5G sites grown from 54 to 149 on 700MHz
Econet Wi-Fi Plus fixed-mobile convergence service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-07-11
International internet gateways	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Described in the regulator's sector review
Lesotho Internet Exchange Point	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Relaunched after a revamp, February 2026
Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network (LEMOFI)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Feasibility study completed, per the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19
Managed satellite enterprise broadband	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the incumbent mobile operator, August 2026
Regulator ruling on unnotified airtime restrictions	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Regulator found against the operator and ordered the restriction reversed
Starlink operating licence	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Ten-year satellite internet licence granted by the LCA, 2025-04-14
Starlink satellite internet service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller, 2025-06-30

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Vodacom Lesotho mobile network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Thirtieth-anniversary account of the network, 2026-06-17

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National data-centre implementation roadmap	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Drafting workshop opened in Maseru 2026-08-17
Project Kobong hydropower and AI data centre	PLANNED ↗	Approved and launched at a ceremony hosted by the US Embassy, 2026-07-31
Regulator disaster-recovery site	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Equipment procurement opened, August 2025
Vodacom Lesotho data centres	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Two sites named on the operator's own service pages

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ASCENT-Lesotho energy access project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Announced as a \$50m IDA credit, May 2026
Mantsonyane grid extension	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the rural electrification unit, August 2025
National Energy Compact	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First quarterly progress report published, March 2026

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government ICT estate	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Assessed in a World Bank project appraisal, March 2023
Mohale's Hoek government data centre	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Toured near-complete by the Communications Minister; power station awaited (~2018-07)

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government Chief Information Security Officer	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First appointment across government reported 2026-07-29
Interim national CSIRT (LesComCSIRT)	IMPLEMENTED, INTERIM ↗	Launched in Maseru 2026-07-29
National Cybersecurity Forum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugural meeting 2026-07-29
National Security Operations Centre	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Reported being stood up, 2026-07-29
National Cybersecurity Strategy	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-10 – OXFORD/C3SA CYBERSECURITY CAPACITY MATURITY MODEL REVIEW RATED THE STRATEGY DIMENSION START-UP AND FOUND NO OFFICIAL NCS	Oxford/C3SA Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review confirmed no official National Cybersecurity Strategy, 2023-03-31

The mobile market has two operators and a satellite entrant. Vodacom Lesotho reported **1.21m customers and 85% market share at its thirtieth anniversary in June 2026**, on 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, with 4G reaching 96% of the population; a US\$40m upgrade was **announced in March 2026**. Econet Telecom Lesotho's most recent published network figure is **149 5G sites on 700MHz in June 2025**, and nothing later is held. A separate fibre backbone, the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network, had its feasibility study completed by the time of the **2025/26 budget speech of 19 February 2025**, with no construction reported since.

Starlink holds a ten-year licence [granted on 14 April 2025](#) and has been retailing through T-Connect since June 2025. [The rights group Section 2 objected](#) that full foreign ownership departs from the local-participation terms attached to both mobile operators, and Vodacom's appeal for local shareholding has no recorded outcome.

The [Mohale's Hoek data centre was toured near-complete on 24 May 2018](#), a Tier III design built as 100km-separated backup to the Finance Ministry's Maseru data centre, left needing only its power station; no later source confirms completion or operational status. Project Kobong is the newer and far larger commitment: no rack, floor-area or power figure has been published for it either, and the project's own premise is that the electricity does not yet exist – about 72MW installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, with [438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 imported](#).

The cybersecurity institutions are new and, in the case of the response team, explicitly interim. Alongside the CSIRT and the National Cybersecurity Forum, the ministry reports a first Chief Information Security Officer appointed across government and a Security Operations Centre being stood up, for which no host, operator or date is [published](#); the same centre was first budgeted, as a Government Security Operations Centre, in the [2025/26 budget speech](#) more than a year earlier. The minister dates the threat they answer to an attack on the government financial system in June 2023 that forced a shutdown, an attack on the Central Bank roughly six months later that stopped bank transfers, and attacks on the Judiciary's electronic systems. An [Oxford/C3SA capacity review](#) found the strategy the launch invoked did not officially exist as of 31 March 2023.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil registration and social protection linkage	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Digital birth registration feeding the social registry
Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Under development, per the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19
Health system interoperability	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultancy commissioned to integrate project systems with the national platform
National Single Window	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at Victory Hall, Maseru, 24 August 2026
X-Road government interoperability platform	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Presented at the MICSTI-NUL review of DPI progress, 2026-02-20

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil registration and identity modernisation framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Five-day design workshop opened by the home affairs ministry, June 2026
Digital birth registration under Ntlafatsa Bana	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with the European Union and UNICEF, 2025-04-02
Digital service-ID pilot	PILOTING ↗	Pilot programme set to begin 2026-04-02, about 10,000 participants, announced 2026-03-25
Identity card as a cross-border travel document	PLANNED ↗	Proposed for the South Africa border, April 2026
Identity number issued at birth registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Confirmed in the registry's own presentation, July 2026
Identity verification in financial services	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Recorded in the financial sector development strategy, November 2025
MOSIP-based integrated national digital ID	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	2026 work plan signed by MICSTI and UNICEF, 2026-03-03
National Identification System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Documented in the World Bank GovTech case study, 2022
National Identity Register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Assessed by the World Bank, May 2022

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Refugee identity-document freeze	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported as leaving families stranded and bank accounts frozen, August 2026

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EcoCash mobile money	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Platform migration completed October 2024
Financial Consumer Protection Act 2022	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Establishes the consumer-protection regime and the central bank's powers under it
Financial consumer protection regulations	ENACTED ↗	Three implementing regulations reached Senate adoption, May 2026
Lekuka national e-invoicing platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Nationwide rollout reported, August 2026
LeSwitch national payment switch	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Card transactions at point of sale localised from 2025-05-11
M-Pesa Lesotho (VCL Financial Services)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mobile money spun off into VCL Financial Services, 2026-03-13
Renminbi settlement access through CIPS	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Standard Bank extended CIPS access beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho
Revenue Services Lesotho tax e-payment integration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with Standard Lesotho Bank, 2026-02-11
Tsetela wallet investment service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in Maseru 2026-07-22

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Business Facilitation Single Window	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Confirmed under the World Bank-funded competitiveness project
Geddit digital address platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched privately, May 2026
General register of electors	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Constituted under section 66 of the Constitution and the 2011 electoral Act
Land holding database	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The Land Administration Authority is charged with maintaining it under the 2010 Act
Land Regulations 2011	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Made under the Land Act 2010; carry the allocation and identification registers
National Spatial Development Infrastructure Policy	PLANNED ↗	Proposed by officials, May 2026
NISSA social registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Child-centred redesign piloted in Mafeteng District
Registrar of Companies	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Established by the Companies Act 2011
Taxpayer register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Authorised by section 7(1) of the Revenue Authority Act 2001
National address register	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31	Officials stated no spatial-data policy exists, May 2026

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ASYCUDAWorld customs system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Rolled out to all commercial borders in 2015/16
Automated case management system	PLANNED ↗	Needs assessment reported still in progress, February 2023
Decision Support System for planning and budgeting	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Presented at the MICSTI-NUL review of DPI progress, 2026-02-20
E-Taxation Platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operational guide published by the revenue authority

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Foundational Literacy and Numeracy Dashboard	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	UNICEF and Global Partnership for Education support announced, 2026-07-23
Land Administration Authority geographic information system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Recognised by a regional award, November 2021
Lehokela crime-reporting platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	National launch, April 2026
Lesotho Education Management Information System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Rollout reported against the DHIS2 platform, May 2026
MISSA social-assistance management information system	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Request for proposals closed 12 August 2024
National monitoring and evaluation reporting capacity	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Consultancy advertised 2026-08-16
Teacher Management Information System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Development informed by a peer exchange with Zambia

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
E-Parliament system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Completion reported in the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19
eGovernment Infrastructure Project Phase II	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Digital Outreach Studio launched under the project, 2026-06-12
National Data Value Creation Blueprint	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First national stakeholder consultative workshop, 14-15 July 2026
Separate government ICT agency	PLANNED ↗	Announced as a plan to move ICT services out of the civil service, 2026-07-29

Payments are the deepest part of the base. LeSwitch has localised instant transfers, ATM transactions and, since May 2025, card transactions at point of sale; e-commerce and retail were named as the next stage and nothing since is held. On top of it, Vodacom's mobile money was [reconstituted as VCL Financial Services in March 2026](#) and runs 14,000 agents, Econet's EcoCash has been on a [migrated platform since October 2024](#), and Tsetela opened investment from M50 for individual customers and M300 for group-savings customers over USSD. Two narrower rails were added in 2026: [tax e-payment](#) for company tax, PAYE, VAT and customs duties, and [renminbi settlement through CIPS](#).

Identity is the layer with the widest gap between activity and delivery. The National Identification System operates, but the most recent account of it held here is a [World Bank case study from 2022](#), so no current coverage or enrolment figure can be given. The replacement is a [MOSIP-based integrated national digital ID](#) under a 2026 work plan with UNICEF, covering passport and identity-card renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification. A separate [digital service-ID pilot](#) of about 10,000 participants was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin 2 April 2026, tying registration to an existing national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration; no vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria has been stated. [Digital birth registration](#) runs under the Ntlafatsa Bana programme.

The interoperability and analytics layers are at presentation stage. X-Road and a Decision Support System were both [shown as work in progress in February 2026](#) with no go-live date, alongside a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework named as under development in the [2025/26 budget speech](#), aimed at government efficiency and avoiding fragmented ICT procurement. The [NISSA](#) registry is the exception — it is in operation and is being redesigned around children's data — while its management information system, MISSA, has not moved past a [request for proposals that closed in August 2024](#). The [eGovernment Infrastructure Project Phase](#)

II, an African Development Bank commitment of US\$13.95m made in 2019 and due to end in 2026, is the standing financing behind this layer; the same budget speech reported an E-Parliament system already completed, modernising legislative processes.

Sub-national government has one system on record: Maseru City Council's [Construction Permit Automation System](#), built by Computer Business Solutions (Lesotho) with Web Masters Kenya under World Bank funding, live at mcc-cp.org.ls from application through to digital permit issue.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Community council internet connection programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First council connected, with a stated plan to reach all of them
Maseru City Council Construction Permit Automation System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Project page dated 2025-04-02; live at mcc-cp.org.ls

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Community-based chronic care programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Trial results published, February 2026
Police station computer handover	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Twenty desktop computers handed to the police service, June 2026
Police station Wi-Fi programme	PLANNED ↗	Universal service fund procurement opened, July 2026
SMS birth registration stations	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Thirty stations established, August 2026
T-Connect Impact school and clinic connectivity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at Soofia International School, Butha-Buthe, 2026-01-17

Sub-national digitalisation is one connectivity programme rather than a service layer: [T-Connect Impact](#) connects schools and clinics, launched at Butha-Buthe in January 2026. No site count or funding line is held.

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Agricultural extension chatbot	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Content validation under way ahead of a pilot
AI Policy implementation plan	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft implementation plan prepared, January 2025
Computer-aided tuberculosis screening	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Use confirmed in a peer-reviewed study, June 2025
Deepfake impersonation of the head of state	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Government press statement warning the public, August 2025
National AI Academy	PLANNED ↗	Named in the UNDP-Econet memorandum signed 2026-07-28
Sesotho word bank	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Compilation work reported, February 2026
World AI Cooperation Organization membership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Founding agreement signed in Shanghai, July 2026

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Private-sector cloud and cybersecurity capacity	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Executive workshop hosted in Maseru by DNS Technologies and CBS, 2026-05-30

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CAFI Entrepreneurship Hub	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Fifth incubation cycle opened, March 2026
Software Factory Hub	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First cohort graduated, October 2025
UNDP-Econet memorandum of understanding	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed at the Mpilo Boutique Hotel, Maseru, 2026-07-28
UniPOD digital studio	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Declared operational at Lerotholi Polytechnic, June 2026

The artificial-intelligence position is an approved data-centre project, a signed policy whose text is not held, and one institutional commitment. A [National AI Academy](#) is proposed in the memorandum Econet Telecom Lesotho and UNDP signed on 28 July 2026, with no timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution named; the same memorandum renews a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022, and states no amount, term or deliverable.

Two external relationships shape the sector. The [Lesotho–India memorandum](#) of July 2025 named digital ID, a unified payment environment and once-only information exchange as the year's priorities, and no deliverable under it is on record. On the American side, the [US Embassy states](#) that it has facilitated US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships in Lesotho over eighteen months, of which Kobong is the largest — the embassy's own figure, attributed as such.

Domestic technology capacity outside the two operators appears once, as an [executive workshop in Maseru](#) on ransomware, cloud security and data sovereignty.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Public service ICT training programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Courses listed by the public service ministry

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI literacy in digital skills learning labs	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Content rolled into the learning labs, March 2026
AI Skills Development Programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with the US Embassy under the Sebatatso initiative, 2026-06-17
Education improvement laptop procurement	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Procurement opened for 500 laptops with mandatory ICT training
Government digital-literacy training in all ten districts	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported running across all ten districts, 2026-07-29
Vodacom and AWS digital-skills training	PLANNED ↗	Pledged at the Vodacom group chief executive's visit, 2025-08-25

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government and National University of Lesotho DPI collaboration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joint review of DPI progress with the Mathematics and Computer Science department, 2026-02-20

Research capacity is a single standing collaboration: the ministry and the [National University of Lesotho](#) jointly [review digital public infrastructure progress](#). No research output, funded programme or centre mandate is held behind it.

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Accessible digital library and insight centre	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed with the incumbent operator, March 2026
National Contact Centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened as the citizen feedback mechanism, May 2022
Ombudsman complaints management system	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Procurement opened, October 2025
Persons with Disability Equity Act 2021	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Establishes the advisory council and accessible-communication duties
Refugee biometric identity registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Biometric registration system handed to government, October 2018
Women in digital inclusion work	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Dedicated forum held on the Commonwealth digital roadshow, April 2026

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Community Digital Inclusion Model	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Moved from pilot to universal service fund management
Schools Connectivity Programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools connected, November 2025

The government's own measure of the access problem is coverage against use: [100% broadband coverage](#) and [about 50% regular internet use](#), which MICSTI attributed to affordability at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026. Rural reach is being extended by satellite rather than by terrestrial network: [community hotspots](#) handed over through principal chiefs, and [school and clinic connectivity](#) from January 2026.

Training is thin and externally supplied. The [AI Skills Development Programme](#) with the US Embassy is the one programme on record delivering, digital-literacy training is reported across all ten districts with no participant numbers published, and a digital-skills pledge made with AWS in August 2025 has nothing recorded against it since.

As South African remittance and banking rules tightened, [migrant workers moved from banks to fintechs](#). No domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation is held, so what the state itself spends cannot be stated.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital census data capture	IMPLEMENTED ↗	2,750 tablets and 1,045 power banks delivered, March 2026
National Strategy for the Development of Statistics	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Listed by the Bureau of Statistics as its current strategy, covering 2022/23 to 2026/27
Population and Housing Census	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Seventh census enumeration completed, June 2026
Vital statistics from civil registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Report number four published, on 2022 reference-year records

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National open data portal	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-31	The National Digital Policy records no open government data legislation promulgated

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Meteorological observing network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Technical assistance opened to modernise it, September 2025
Meteorological satellite products	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In the regional cascading forecasting framework
National land cover mapping	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operational Sentinel-2 mapping built for the catchment programme
Satellite-based food security monitoring	IMPLEMENTED ↗	June 2026 outlook published

No national open-data portal is held, and a capacity assessment searched in August 2026 found no active government open-data programme and no access-to-information legislation in force. That is a searched absence rather than a gap in this document.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
US commercial diplomacy in the digital and energy sectors	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US Embassy states US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated over eighteen months

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Dubai data-centre investment pitch	PLANNED ↗	Presented to Dubai Chambers, June 2026
Gulf bilateral labour arrangements	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Status set out by the minister, May 2026
Saudi airport rehabilitation commitment	PLANNED ↗	Reaffirmed on the presentation of credentials, February 2026

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Lesotho-India digital public infrastructure memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed during the Indian minister of state's visit to Maseru, 2025-07-29

The external digital relationship on record is with India: a digital public infrastructure memorandum [signed during an Indian minister of state visit to Maseru in July 2025](#). Nothing on file records work done under it.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National open data portal	A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.	2026-08-31
AI legislation or regulations	an AI Act, or regulations made under an existing statute, with a gazette reference	2026-08-31
National address register	a state address register or addressing standard with a coverage figure, or a ministerial statement that the private platform is the national one	2026-08-31

Two absences remain. The National Cybersecurity Strategy is invoked in official statements but has no published text; an [Oxford/C3SA capacity review](#) rated its strategy dimension Start-up and found no official strategy existed as of 31 March 2023, and nothing later on record supersedes that finding. No National open data portal is held either; an [SBC4D/IREX capacity assessment](#) found no active government open-data programme as of September 2021, and nothing later on record supersedes that finding.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-31
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/LSO/LSO-status.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/LSO/LSO-status-2026-08-31.pdf
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